

Double Or Nothing!

Much before the CPU got there, multi-core Graphical Processing Units (GPUs) have invaded our PCs. These graphics monsters are pushing the bar higher for every manufacturer and every component inside a PC. Everything else is just trying to catch up. We look at what makes the latest multi-GPU cards tick

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There was a time when graphics was a simple deal—get a card, push it into a free PCI (Peripheral Component Interconnect) slot, and merrily start installing games such as *Half-Life*! Then they complicated things by introducing the AGP (Accelerated Graphics Port) slot on motherboards. This meant we had to upgrade our motherboards. Before we knew it, there were differences between 1x, 2x, 4x and 8x AGP motherboards; and since the newer 4x and 8x AGP cards were not backward-compatible with the older 1x and 2x AGP cards, the few who insisted on the best upgraded again and again!

Next, they upgraded the old PCI slots with higher bandwidth capacities, and the new PCI-express (PCIe) port was born; we all upgraded again! Someone at nVidia reinvented the SLI technology, and SLI graphics was born; some of us upgraded, yet again.

Sounds like a history lesson? Well, all this happened in less than five years! So as far as the